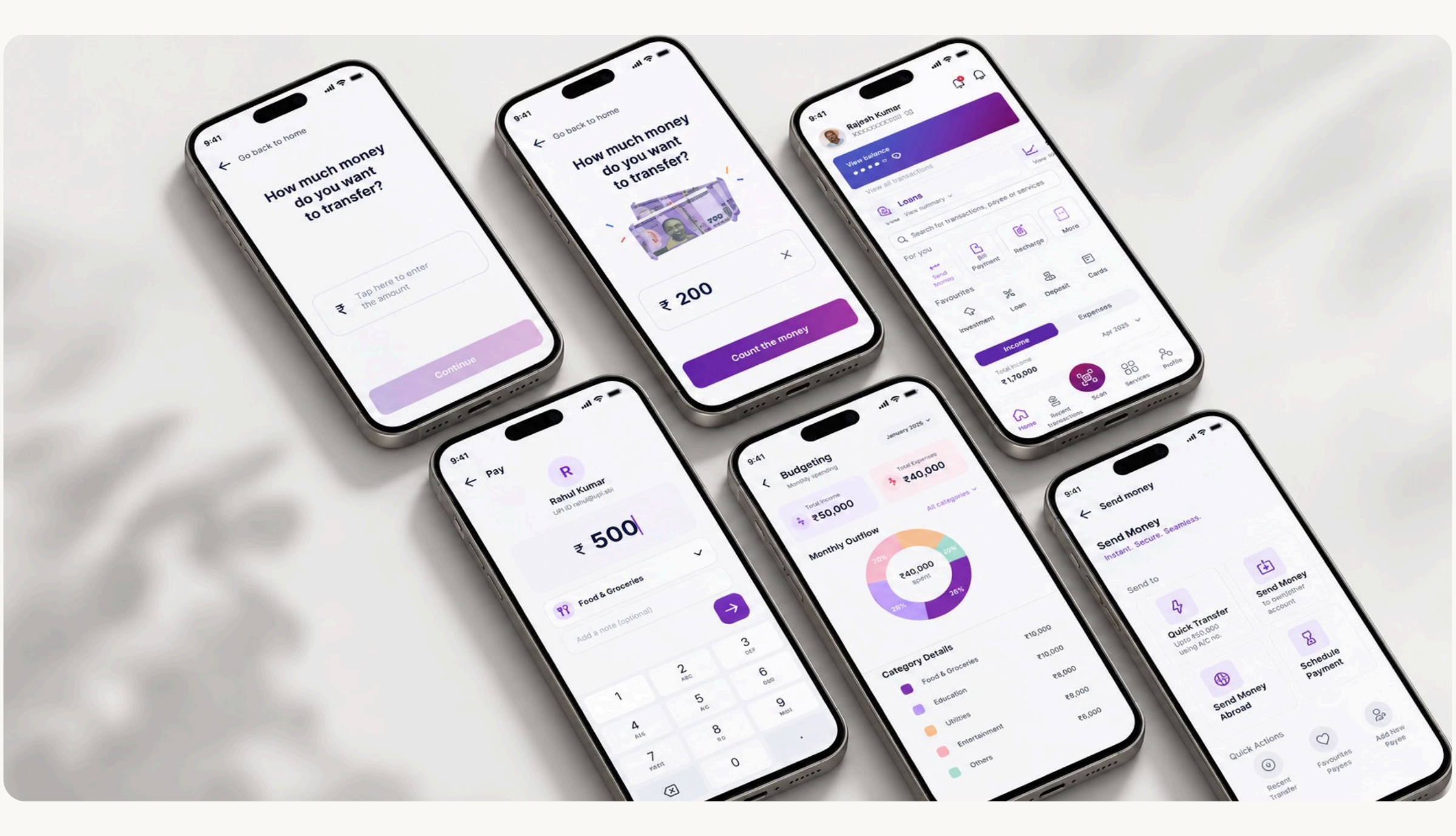
Making YONO SBI Easier for Different Kinds of Users

Redesigning core banking experiences for different users, and their different needs.

My Role
UX Research, Usability testing, UI Design

Team
Aradhika & Khushboo

Tools Used
Moderated Testing, Think aloud method, 5s test, card sorting, A/B Testing


How much money do you want to transfer?
₹ 200
Count the money
Pay
Rahul Kumar
₹ 500
Food & Groceries
Budgeting
Monthly Outflow
Category Details
Send money
Quick Transfer
Send Money Abroad
Schedule Payment

Testing YONO SBI with six different users.

We tested the YONO SBI app with 6 users to understand how familiarity, banking experience and digital confidence shaped their experience. the study focused on checking balance, transactions, sending money, and adding payee.

Tested with:

Regular YONO user
Familiar with the app and everyday banking tasks

SBI user, but new to YONO
Familiar with SBI banking, but new to its mobile app

First time YONO user
Helpful until they get used to it

Young digital user
Used to quick UPI experiences and other digital payment apps.

Occasional user
Uses the app infrequently

Senior user
Rarely uses YONO independently

Pain points

1. **Different users had different needs**
Regular users wanted transaction and bill payments, while young users wanted budgeting and spending alert

2. **No personalization**
The same experience was shown to users with different needs and priorities

3. **Frequent actions were harder to reach**
Most used actions were not easily accessible

4. **Low error prevention**
Network issue created fear of failed or duplicate payments, especially in senior users

Participants

01 Regular User Of Yono
Prathmesh Waliokar
Age 35-40,
Architect and Professor

02 Account Holder (Non-YONO User)
Rajat Akre
Age 35-40,
Professor + UI/UX Designer

03 First time User Of Yono
Sheela Patil
Age 45-50,
Housewife

04 Non-SBI User
Hemchand Pavnikar
Age 21
College student

05 Occasional User
Ranjana Satpute
Age 40-50,
Housewife

06 Senior User
Rekha Ghorse
Age 60+,
Housewife

Tasks Tested

We tested three core banking tasks to understand how easily users could find, understand and complete everyday actions on YONO.

01 View Balance & Transactions
Users completed the task, but balance visibility and the eye icon were unclear, especially for first-time and senior users.

Task completion: 100% — Completed 10/10 users
Average time taken: 30 sec
Error rate: 10–20% (0% – 100%)

Key issues observed
- Balance not immediately visible
- Eye icon unclear
- New users relied on scanning

02 Add new payee
Similar options like UPI, Quick Transfer and Fund Transfer created confusion, wrong paths and unnecessary exploration.

Task completion: 85% — Completed 9/10 users; Could not complete 1/10 users
Average time taken: 1 min
Error rate: 40–50% (0% – 100%)

Key issues observed
- Confusion between UPI, Quick Transfer and Fund Transfer
- Wrong option selection
- Unnecessary exploration to find the right flow

03 Tranffer money to added payee
The longest and most difficult flow. Users faced input errors, unclear terminology, app-switching issues and uncertainty after adding a payee.

Task completion: 65% — Completed 6/10 users; Could not complete 4/10 users
Average time taken: 2–3 min
Error rate: 55% (0% – 100%)

Key issues observed
- Input errors during details entry
- Unclear terminology
- App-switching for OTP/verification
- Uncertainty after adding a payee

What did we Learn?

Important actions as per the individual, were hard to find
Core actions were available, but users often had to scan , search and explore to find them.

Confusing transaction labelings
Similar transfer options and unclear labels created hesitation and incorrect paths

Different uses needed different support
Experienced users moved faster, while 1st time occasional and senior users needed greater visibility

Some users wanted budgeting feature
users said they wanted something extra, other than banking services like budgeting feature to use that app frequently

Elderly users are less comfortable with online transfers.
as money is represented only through numbers.

Confirmation screen lacked information about cooling period
causing users to repeat the process unnecessarily.

User needs

1. **Easy access to frequent actions**
Users need their most used actions visible and easy

2. **Simplicity**
Want to see what matters to them without getting overwhelmed by unnecessary options

3. **Better money management**
3 out of 6 users mentioned that a budgeting feature would help them manage their money better

4. **Error prevention, especially during network issues**
Users need clear guidance before errors, and confirmation confirmation after transactio

Solution

Tag important action
Users can add tags like "Favourite" to actions they want quick access to

Simple home section
Showing only relevant options

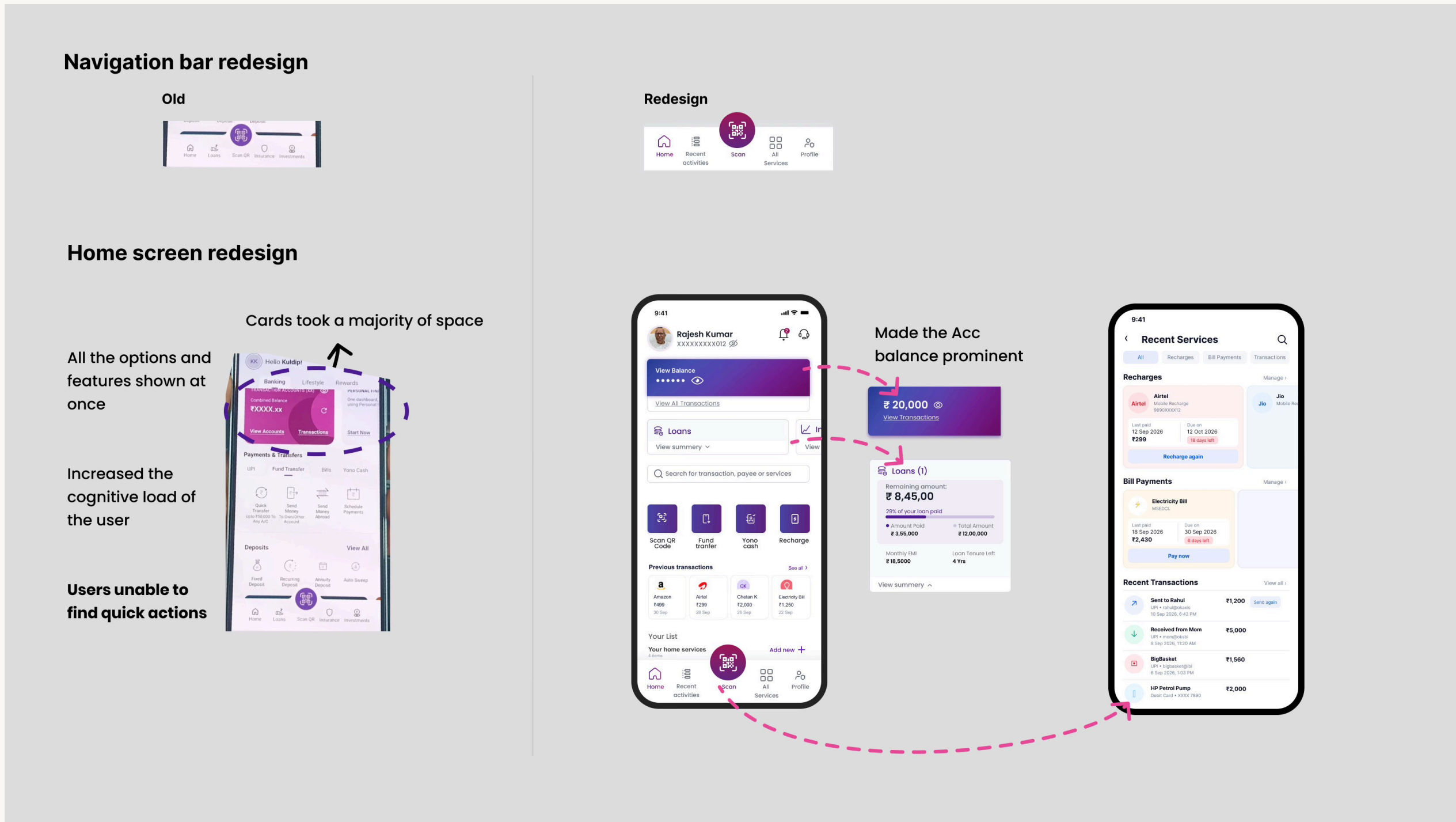
Frequently used tasks visible
Common actions automatically appear on the home screen

Budgeting and spending
A budgeting feature that helps spending and tracking of the money

Visualization of real notes while money tranfer
Shows money as familiar notes, making transfers easier to understand.

Warn users before duplicate transfers
A pop-up warning before an immediate transaction of a similar amount.

High-fidelity screens


Navigation bar redesign

Old

Redesign

Home screen redesign

Cards took a majority of space

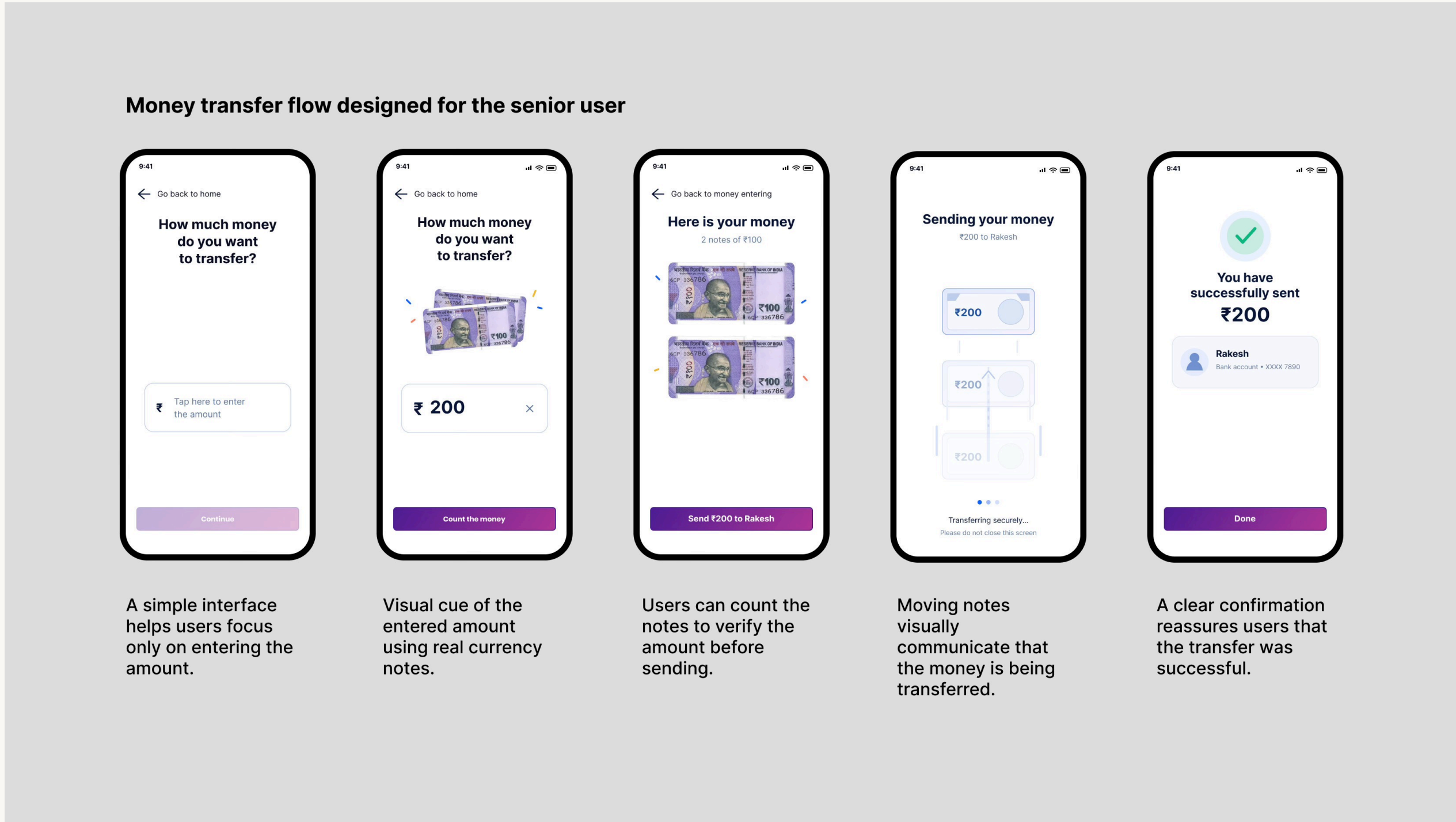
All the options and features shown at once

Increased the cognitive load of the user

Users unable to find quick actions

Made the Acc balance prominent

Home
Recent activities
Scan
All Services
Profile
Rajesh Kumar
View Balance
₹ 20,000
Loans
₹ 8,45,00
Scan QR Code
Fund transfer
Yono cash
Recharge
Previous transactions
Recent Services
Recharges
Bill Payments
Recent Transactions


Money transfer flow designed for the senior user

A simple interface helps users focus only on entering the amount.

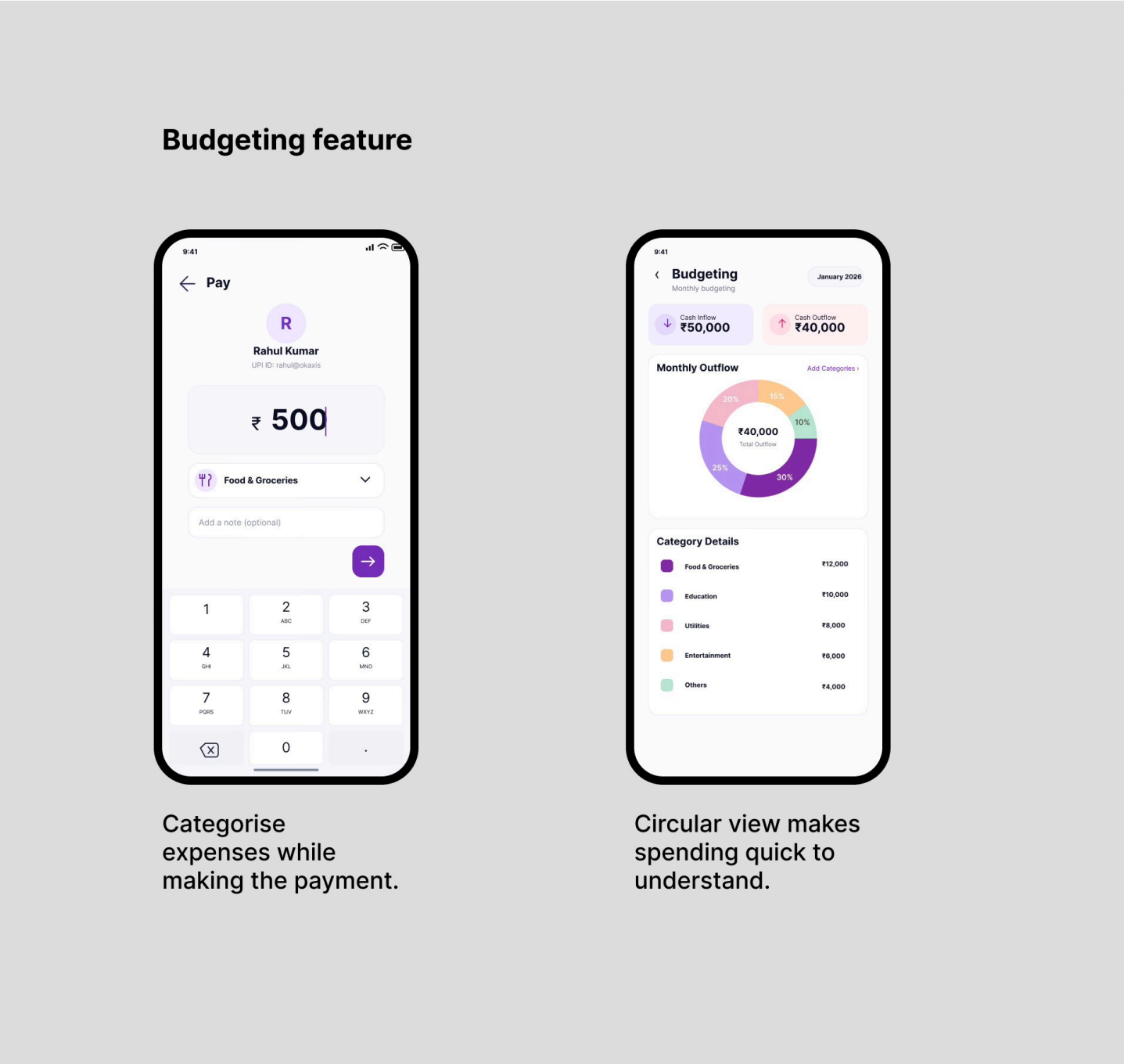
Visual cue of the entered amount using real currency notes.

Users can count the notes to verify the amount before sending.

Moving notes visually communicate that the money is being transferred.

A clear confirmation reassures users that the transfer was successful.

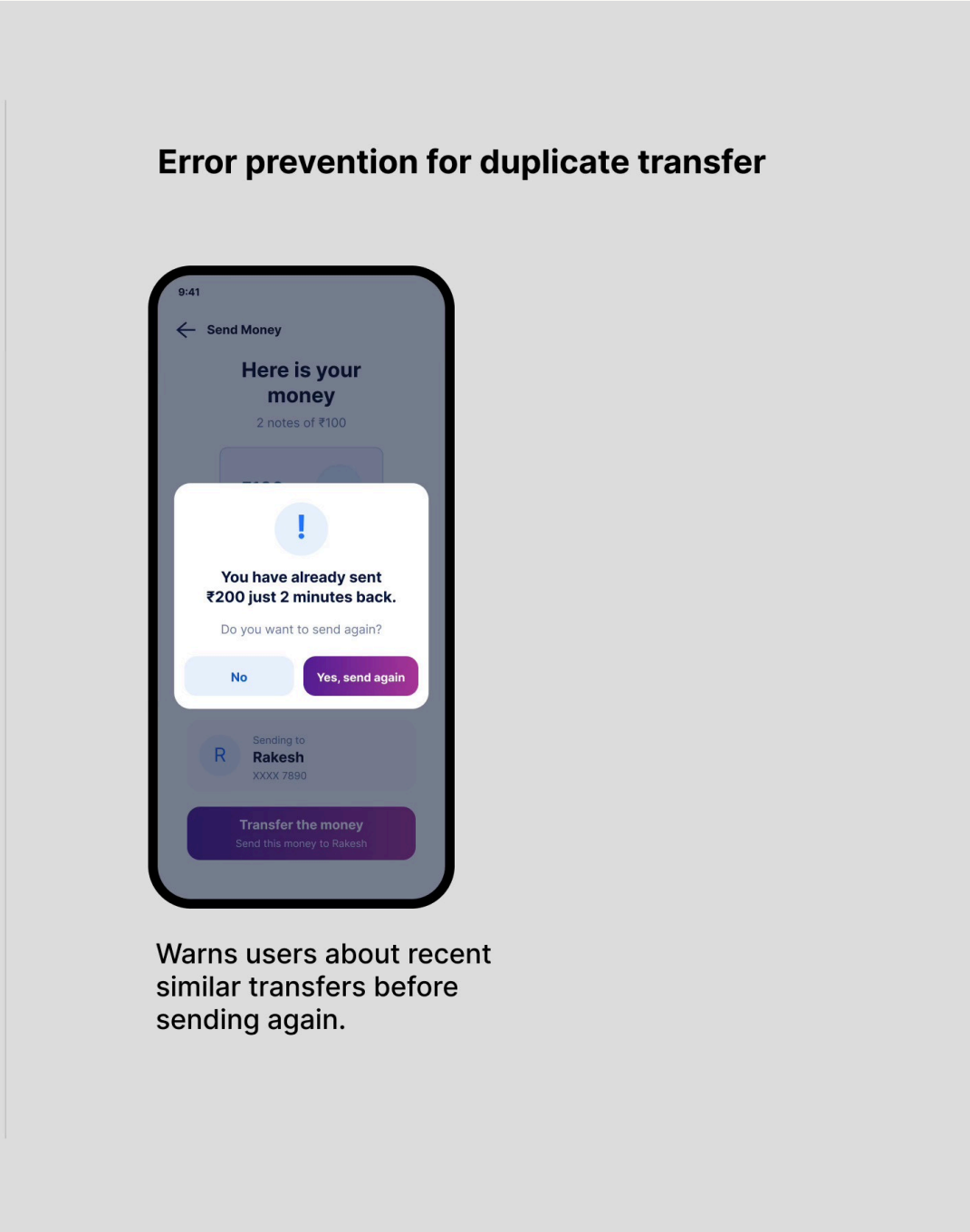
Go back to home
How much money do you want to transfer?
Tap here to enter the amount
Continue
₹ 200
Count the money
Here is your money
2 notes of ₹100
Send ₹200 to Rakesh
Sending your money
Transferring securely...
You have successfully sent ₹200
Rakesh
Done


Budgeting feature

Categorise expenses while making the payment.

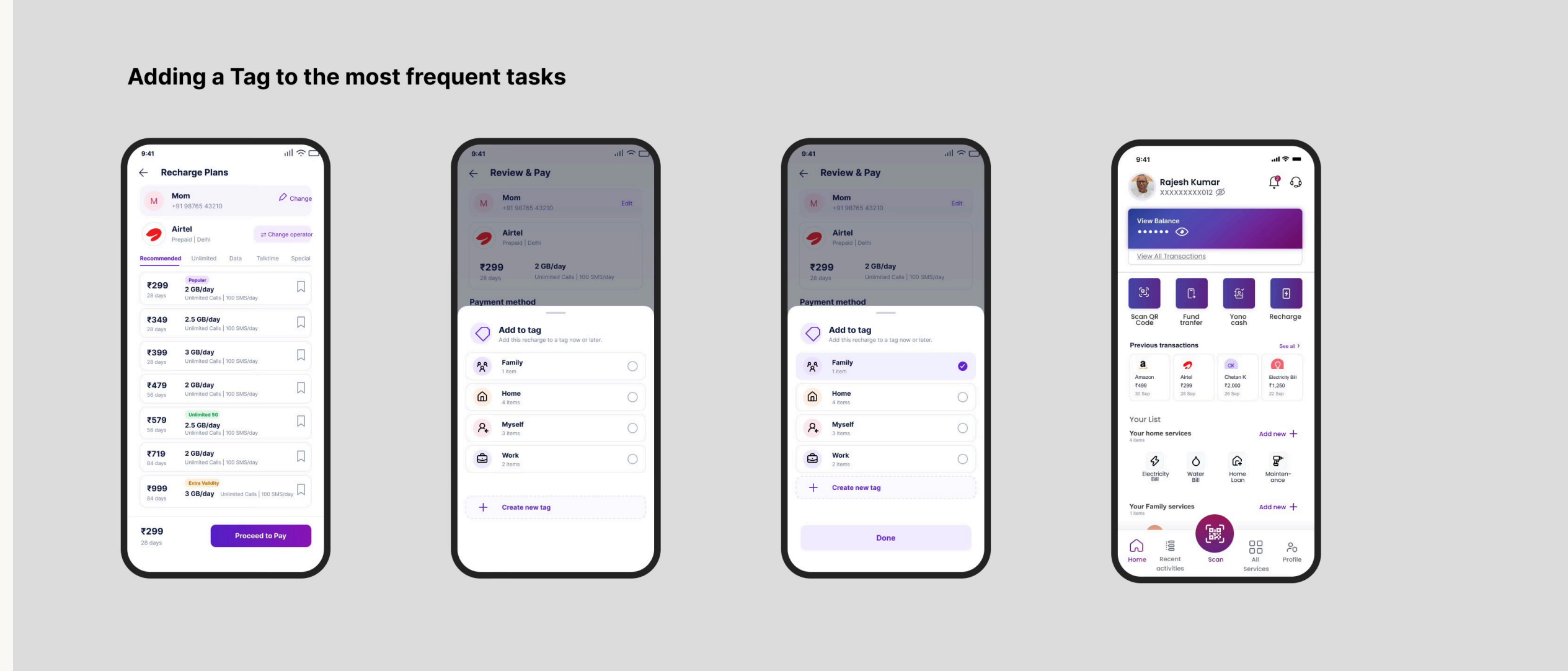
Circular view makes spending quick to understand.

Pay
Rahul Kumar
₹ 500
Food & Groceries
Budgeting
₹50,000
₹40,000
Monthly Outflow
Category Details


Error prevention for duplicate transfer

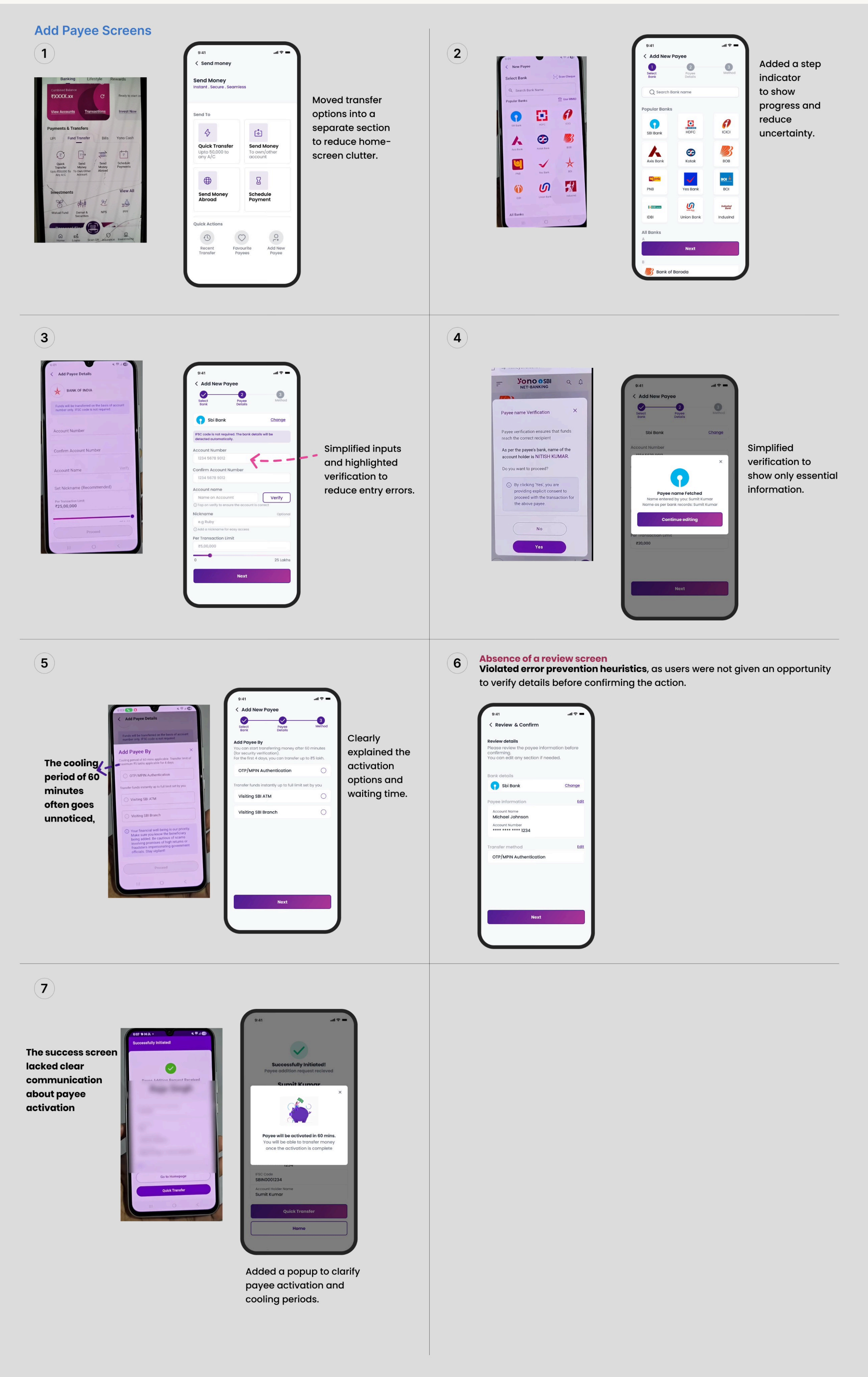
Warns users about recent similar transfers before sending again.

Here is your money
You have already sent ₹200 just 2 minutes back.
Do you want to send again?
No
Yes, send again
Rakesh
Transfer the money


Adding a Tag to the most frequent tasks

Recharge Plans
Mom
Airtel
Proceed to Pay
Review & Pay
Add to tag
Family
Home
Myself
Work
Create new tag
Done
Rajesh Kumar

Refined usability task flow


Add Payee Screens

1
Moved transfer options into a separate section to reduce home-screen clutter.

2
Added a step indicator to show progress and reduce uncertainty.

3
Simplified inputs and highlighted verification to reduce entry errors.

4
Simplified verification to show only essential information.

5
The cooling period of 60 minutes often goes unnoticed,

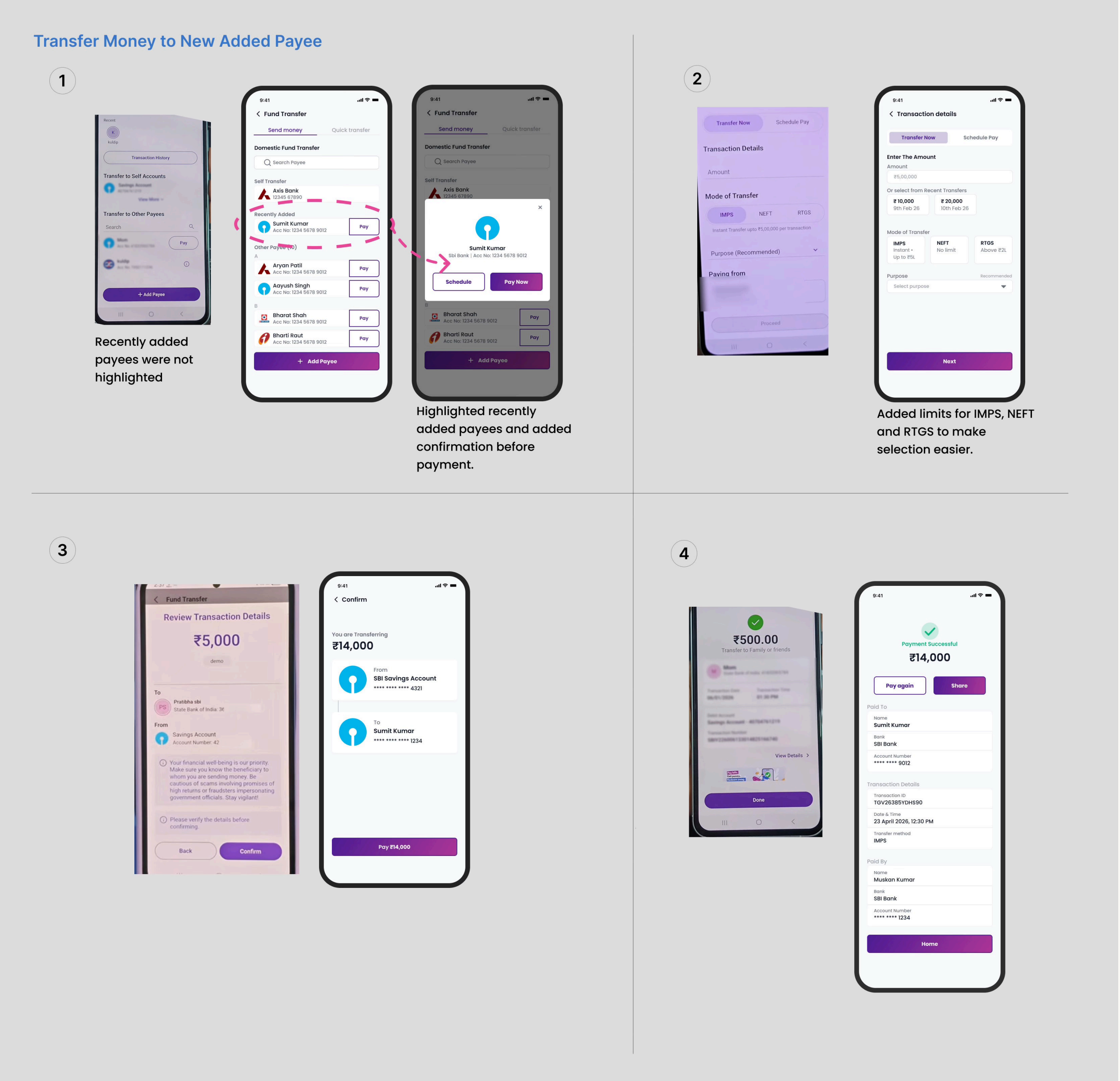
Clearly explained the activation options and waiting time.

6
Absence of a review screen
Violated error prevention heuristics, as users were not given an opportunity to verify details before confirming the action.

7
The success screen lacked clear communication about payee activation

Added a popup to clarify payee activation and cooling periods.

Send Money
Quick Transfer
Send Money Abroad
Schedule Payment
Add New Payee
Payee name fetched
Continue adding
Review & Confirm
Payee will be activated in 60 mins.
You will be able to transfer money once the activation is complete
Quick Transfer
Home


Transfer Money to New Added Payee

1
Recently added payees were not highlighted

Highlighted recently added payees and added confirmation before payment.

2
Added limits for IMPS, NEFT and RTGS to make selection easier.

3

4

Fund Transfer
Send money
Quick transfer
Domestic Fund Transfer
Search Payee
Self Transfer
Axis Bank
Recently Added
Sumit Kumar
Pay
Other Payees
Aryan Patil
Aayush Singh
Bharat Shah
Bharti Raut
Add Payee
Schedule
Pay Now
Transaction details
Transfer Now
Schedule Pay
Enter The Amount
Mode of Transfer
IMPS
NEFT
RTGS
Purpose
Next
Review Transaction Details
₹5,000
Back
Confirm
You are Transferring
₹14,000
SBI Savings Account
Sumit Kumar
Pay ₹14,000
₹500.00
Done
Payment Successful
₹14,000
Pay again
Share
Home

A/B Testing insights

I tested the redesign in two rounds first to validate the core banking flows, and later to test the new features that emerged from the research.

Round 1 — Testing the core redesign

		Complition rate	Error clicks	Avg. Time taken	Satisfaction rate
View balance & transaction	Before	85%	2+	30s to 1 min	3.1 out of 5
	After	100%	0	Less than 10s	4.7 out of 5
Add new payee	Before	100% (difficulty)	6+	3 to 6 mins	2.5 out of 5
	After	100%	0	1 to 1.5 mins	4.4 out of 5
Transfer money to payee	Before	100%	0	1 min	3.0 out of 5
	After	100%	0	50s to 1 min	4.5 out of 5

Outcomes

Part 01 — The flow redesign

Core tasks became easier to complete
Task completion improved to 100%, with error clicks dropping to 0 in the tested redesigned flows.

Everyday banking became much faster
Balance checking reduced to <10 sec, while Send Money reduced from 3–6 min to 1–1.5 min.

Users felt more satisfied
Satisfaction improved across the tested flows, reaching 4.4–4.7

Part 02 — Testing the add-on features

I then tested the new tagging, repeat recharge and recent activity features with 15 more users, along with the redesigned Send Money flow with 6 elderly users.

Tags were useful, but needed more clarity
67% found tagging useful, while others were unsure why they would use it.

Repeat activities became easier to access
Tags made frequent tasks easier to find.

Recent transaction needed better visibility
Received money felt hidden.

Visual money increased assurance - elderly part
Currency notes helped verify the amount,
but entering it remained difficult.

Budgeting added more value
Budgeting added value, with visible categories preferred.

CASE CLOSED.